IN THE UNITED STATES DISTRICT COURT
FOR THE SOUTHERN DISTRICT OF WEST VIRGINIA
CHARLESTON DIVISION

FILED
SEP - 7 2023
RORY L. PERRY II, CLERK
U.S. District Court
Southern District of West Virginia

JOHN ANTHONY CASTRO,
12 Park Place, Mansfield, TX 76063

Plaintiff,

v.

SECRETARY OF STATE ANDREW WARNER,
1900 Kanawha Boulevard E, Charleston, WV 25305

DONALD JOHN TRUMP,
1100 S. Ocean Blvd, Palm Beach, FL 33480

Defendants.

Civil Action No. 2:23-cv-00598

Case No. 2:23-CV-00598

VERIFIED COMPLAINT FOR DECLARATORY AND INJUNCTIVE RELIEF

JOHN ANTHONY CASTRO,
12 Park Place, Mansfield, TX 76063
Plaintiff,
v.
SECRETARY OF STATE ANDREW WARNER,
1900 Kanawha Boulevard E, Charleston, WV 25305
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1100 S. Ocean Blvd, Palm Beach, FL 33480
Defendants.
VERIFIED COMPLAINT FOR DECLARATORY AND INJUNCTIVE RELIEF

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Defendant Donald John Trump previously did and presently continues to provide both aid and comfort to. As such, Plaintiff seeks a declaratory judgment that Defendant Donald John Trump is disqualified under Section 3 of the 14th Amendment. Furthermore, Plaintiff seeks an injunction against Defendant Donald John Trump to prevent the acceptance and/or processing of any ballot access documentation of Defendant Donald John Trump for both the primary election and general election.

A. Plaintiff Has Political Competitor Standing

19 Plaintiff John Anthony Castro intends to either appear on the 2024 Republican primary ballot in this state or to file documentation to be a formally recognized write-in candidate in both the primary and general elections. As such, Plaintiff will maintain "standing" throughout the entire course of this litigation until Tuesday, November 5, 2024, at which time standing will have to be reassessed depending on the circumstances as Plaintiff may still have an injury after the election warranting continued review by the federal judiciary.

20 The Constitution limits the jurisdiction of the federal courts to actual cases or controversies.[1] "One element of the case-or-controversy requirement is that [plaintiffs], based on their complaint, must establish that they have standing to sue."[2] The doctrine of standing, "rooted in the traditional understanding of a case or controversy... developed... to ensure that federal courts do not exceed their authority as it has been traditionally understood."[3] "[T]he 'irreducible constitutional minimum' of standing consists of three elements."[4] The "plaintiff must have (1) suffered an injury in fact, (2) that is fairly traceable to the challenged conduct of the defendant, and (3) that is likely to be redressed by a favorable judicial decision."[5]

21 The United States Court of Appeals for the D.C. Circuit has recognized the concept of *Political Competitor Standing* on the basis that an injury would logically be diminution of votes traceable to the political competitor and redressable by a court.[6] Political Competitor Standing,

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[1] U.S. Const. art. III, § 2, cl. 1, *see also Raines v. Byrd*, 521 U.S. 811, 818 (1997).
[2] *Raines*, 521 U.S. at 818.
[3] *Spokeo, Inc. v. Robins*, 578 U.S. 330 (2016).
[4] *Id.* (quoting *Lujan v. Defenders of Wildlife*, 504 U.S. 555, 560 (1992)).
[5] *Id.*
[6] *See Shays v. FEC*, 414 F.3d 76, 87 (D.C. Cir. 2005).

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2912 Park Place, Mansfield, TX 76063

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Defendants.

Case No. 2:23-CV-00598

VERIFICATION

I, John Anthony Castro, declare as follows:

1. I am the plaintiff in the present case, a U.S. citizen, and an FEC-registered Republican primary presidential candidate (Candidate FEC ID Number P40007320) for the 2024 Presidential Election.

2. I intend to either appear on the 2024 Republican primary ballot in this state or to file documentation to be a formally recognized write-in candidate in both the primary and general elections. As such, I will maintain "standing" throughout the course of this litigation.

3. I have personal first-hand knowledge of all of the factual matters set forth in this document, and, if called upon to testify or give oral arguments, I would competently do so.

4. Pursuant to 28 U.S.C. § 1746 and state [sic], I verify under penalty of perjury that the entirety of the foregoing document is true and correct.

VERIFIED COMPLAINT FOR DECLARATORY AND INJUNCTIVE RELIEF

Executed on September 4, 2023.

/s/ John Anthony Castro
John Anthony Castro